

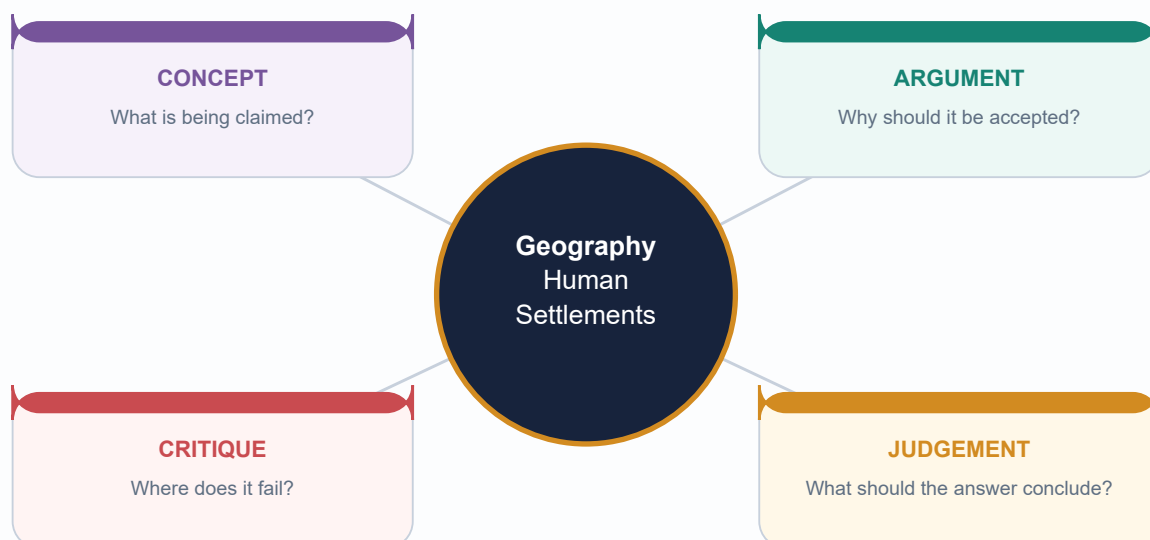
PREMIUM SOLVED-PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Geography 28 - Human Settlements and Urbanisation: Solved Workbook

Geography 28 | GS-I Human Geography + GS-III Urban Infrastructure

Export date / evidence retrieval date: 19 August 2026

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Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

1. Workbook protocol and PYQ provenance

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

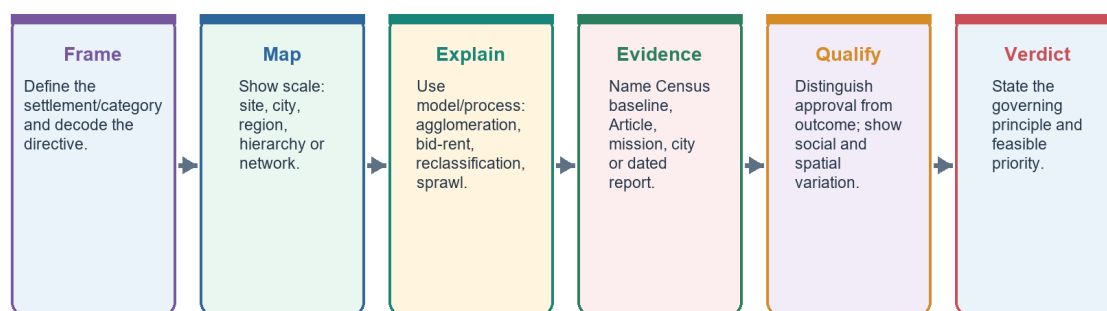
INTRO & ORIGIN

This workbook includes all topic-relevant Mains questions found in the locally available GS-I scans for 2019-2025 and two relevant locally available Prelims questions.

1. WORKBOOK PROTOCOL AND PYQ PROVENANCE

UPSC Answer Spine: Human Settlements and Urbanisation

Definition -> spatial mechanism -> named evidence -> distributional qualification -> verdict



Every paragraph should answer: what, where, why, who gains/loses, what limits the claim, and what follows.

The workbook uses the same examiner-grade answer sequence throughout.

Original deterministic study visual - factual content stated in the caption/text.

STATIC THEORY

- Mains included: 2019 mass transport; 2020 million-city flooding; 2021 water-body reclamation and IT-city implications; 2022 Tier 2 consumption; 2023 segregation; 2024 large-city migration; 2025 smart-city justice.
- Prelims included: 2019 Solid Waste Management Rules Q59; 2024 constitutional Parts Q74.
- The 2019 and 2024 objective keys are treated as officially verified.
- All original hard/remedial MCQs rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D.
- Every Mains model follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict and ends with Why this earns marks.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. No objective answer is presented as inferred.
2. Question wording follows local scans with minor OCR normalisation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A provisional/current-affairs question should be added as a PYQ without a stable key.

CORRECT: Use only verifiable local paper/key evidence for the solved objective set.

MAINS ANGLE

Practice under the original word limit, then compare with the model.

STUDY LINK

[Local official paper archive](#)

HIGH

2. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2025

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** How does smart city in India address the issues of urban poverty and distributive justice? (150 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 10 marks. Directive: Explain how, while evaluating distribution. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Smart-city infrastructure can lower capability deprivation when it improves basic services and public space. **Named evidence/example:** MoHUA Annual Report 2025-26 reported 7,755 of 8,064 Smart Cities projects completed (96%) as on 31 December 2025.. **Analysis:** Digital and physical upgrades can improve reliability, safety and access, but completion is an administrative output.
- **Claim 2:** Distributive justice depends on who receives accessible housing, mobility and services. **Named evidence/example:** PIB reported 16.20 lakh PMAY-U 2.0 houses sanctioned by 13 July 2026; Census 2011 recorded a large historical slum-household baseline.. **Analysis:** Housing location, tenure, occupancy and transport cost determine whether sanctions expand real opportunity.
- **Claim 3:** Participation and citywide scaling matter. **Named evidence/example:** 74th Amendment institutions and ward-level governance.. **Analysis:** Without voice, area-based upgrading can create enclave improvement, displacement or digital exclusion.
- **Qualification:** Smartness is an instrument, not a distributive outcome; city averages can conceal informal and peripheral settlements.
- **Verdict:** A smart city advances justice only when investment is citywide, affordable, participatory and measured through ward-wise service and accessibility outcomes.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

How does smart city in India address the issues of urban poverty and distributive justice? (150 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2025

HIGH

3. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2024

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns? Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries. (150 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 10 marks. Directive: Explain comparative attraction. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Large cities offer thicker labour markets and a wider probability of job matching. **Named evidence/example:** Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru and other metropolitan regions combine formal and informal opportunities.. **Analysis:** Even when unemployment risk exists, expected income and job diversity can exceed small-town options.
- **Claim 2:** Agglomeration concentrates institutions, transport gateways and migrant networks. **Named evidence/example:** Universities, hospitals, airports, wholesale markets and established origin-destination networks.. **Analysis:** Network information lowers migration cost and risk, reinforcing cumulative attraction.
- **Claim 3:** Policy and capital expenditure often privilege metropolitan nodes. **Named evidence/example:** Smart Cities legacy, metro systems and major business districts.. **Analysis:** Infrastructure concentration raises accessibility but also rent, congestion and informality.
- **Qualification:** Smaller towns can intercept migration when they provide reliable services, processing jobs, education, connectivity and affordable housing.
- **Verdict:** Metropolitan attraction reflects cumulative agglomeration and network effects, not simply population size; balanced regional and small-town development can reduce forced concentration.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

*Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns?
Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries. (150 words)*

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2024

HIGH

4. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2023

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Does urbanization lead to more segregation and/or marginalization of the poor in Indian metropolises? (250 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 15 marks. Directive: Critically assess. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Land and housing markets sort low-income households into peripheral or hazardous locations. **Named evidence/example:** Informal settlements near drains, floodplains, industrial edges and distant resettlement colonies..
Analysis: The poor may gain proximity to work only by accepting insecure tenure and environmental risk.
- **Claim 2:** Infrastructure networks can reproduce spatial exclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Unequal water continuity, sewerage, footpaths and public transport across wards..
Analysis: A nominal citywide coverage rate can hide time burdens, high informal prices and unreliable quality.
- **Claim 3:** Redevelopment can improve services but also displace livelihoods. **Named evidence/example:** In-situ upgrading versus relocation approaches under urban housing programmes..
Analysis: Distance from work and social networks can convert a housing asset into livelihood loss.
- **Claim 4:** Urbanisation can also reduce inherited constraints. **Named evidence/example:** Mixed labour markets, education, women's employment and public institutions in large cities..
Analysis: Cities can enable mobility if anti-discrimination, rental housing and universal services are present.
- **Qualification:** Segregation is not an automatic demographic effect of urban growth; it is mediated by planning, tenure, transport, finance and political voice.
- **Verdict:** Indian metropolitan urbanisation often intensifies marginalisation, but inclusive zoning, in-situ improvement, affordable rental housing, universal services and participatory planning can convert density into shared opportunity.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

Does urbanization lead to more segregation and/or marginalization of the poor in Indian metropolises? (250 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2023

HIGH

5. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2022

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** How is the growth of Tier 2 cities related to the rise of a new middle class with an emphasis on the culture of consumption? (150 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 10 marks. Directive: Explain relationship. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Service-sector and administrative expansion raises salaried employment and disposable income. **Named evidence/example:** Regional IT, education, health, logistics and state-capital functions in cities such as Indore, Coimbatore and Bhubaneswar.. **Analysis:** A broader professional class supports durable-goods, housing and leisure demand.
- **Claim 2:** Connectivity and digital retail diffuse metropolitan consumption norms. **Named evidence/example:** Airports, highways, e-commerce, digital payments and social media.. **Analysis:** Market range expands beyond the historic commercial core and reshapes peri-urban land use.
- **Claim 3:** Real-estate and retail landscapes materialise class identity. **Named evidence/example:** Gated housing, malls, branded food, coaching and private health/education.. **Analysis:** Consumption becomes a marker of aspiration while increasing land, waste, traffic and household-debt pressures.
- **Qualification:** Tier 2 is not a uniform official urban category, and new middle classes coexist with informal work, old inequalities and service deficits.
- **Verdict:** Tier 2 growth and consumer middle-class formation are mutually reinforcing, but sustainable urban policy must align consumption-led expansion with public services, productive jobs and ecological limits.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

How is the growth of Tier 2 cities related to the rise of a new middle class with an emphasis on the culture of consumption? (150 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2022

HIGH

6. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2021

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** What are the environmental implications of the reclamation of water bodies into urban land use? Explain with examples. (150 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 10 marks. Directive: Explain impacts with examples. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Reclamation removes stormwater storage and drainage connectivity. **Named evidence/example:** Chennai's wetland and floodplain pressures; Bengaluru's disrupted lake-drain network.. **Analysis:** The same rainfall produces faster runoff, deeper waterlogging and higher downstream peaks.
- **Claim 2:** It erodes groundwater recharge, water quality and habitat. **Named evidence/example:** Urban lakes and wetlands function as recharge, sediment, nutrient and biodiversity systems.. **Analysis:** Converting them to built land transfers treatment and flood-control costs to public infrastructure.
- **Claim 3:** It intensifies heat and locks in exposure. **Named evidence/example:** Loss of blue-green space and construction in low-lying land.. **Analysis:** Heat stress and flood damage become concentrated among residents with weaker housing and insurance.
- **Qualification:** Not every modified water body has identical ecological value; restoration must be catchment-based and avoid cosmetic beautification that disconnects hydrology.
- **Verdict:** Urban water bodies are functional infrastructure; zoning, buffer protection, sewage interception and connected blue-green restoration should precede engineering expansion.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

What are the environmental implications of the reclamation of water bodies into urban land use? Explain with examples. (150 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2021

HIGH

7. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2021

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** What are the main socio-economic implications arising out of the development of IT industries in major cities of India? (250 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 15 marks. Directive: Analyse implications. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** IT clusters create high-productivity employment and global service linkages. **Named evidence/example:** Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Chennai and NCR technology corridors.. **Analysis:** Specialised labour, suppliers and knowledge spillovers strengthen urban agglomeration.
- **Claim 2:** They restructure land use and metropolitan form. **Named evidence/example:** Electronic City and Outer Ring Road-type corridors, airport-oriented growth and gated housing.. **Analysis:** Office corridors pull housing and services outward, producing polycentric but travel-intensive regions.
- **Claim 3:** They widen occupational and spatial dualism. **Named evidence/example:** High-wage professionals depend on lower-paid security, domestic, delivery and construction workers.. **Analysis:** Rent escalation and long commutes can exclude the workforce that sustains the cluster.
- **Claim 4:** They transform gender, consumption and culture. **Named evidence/example:** Young skilled migrants, night-shift work and transnational work cultures.. **Analysis:** New autonomy coexists with safety, care and housing constraints.
- **Qualification:** Technology is not the sole cause; state policy, engineering education, global demand and infrastructure shape each city's trajectory.
- **Verdict:** IT urbanisation raises productivity but must be paired with affordable housing, mass transit, mixed land use, worker protection and metropolitan governance.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

What are the main socio-economic implications arising out of the development of IT industries in major cities of India? (250 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2021

HIGH

8. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2020

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Account for the huge flooding of million cities in India including the smart ones like Hyderabad and Pune. Suggest lasting remedial measures. (250 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 15 marks. Directive: Account for causes and prescribe lasting measures. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Extreme rainfall interacts with expanded impervious cover. **Named evidence/example:** Hyderabad and Pune experienced rapid built-up growth across catchments and drainage paths.. **Analysis:** Runoff volume and speed rise when infiltration and temporary storage decline.
- **Claim 2:** Land-use violations remove natural buffers. **Named evidence/example:** Encroached floodplains, filled lakes/wetlands and construction in low-lying areas.. **Analysis:** Hazard becomes disaster through planning decisions rather than rainfall alone.
- **Claim 3:** Drainage and solid-waste systems fail as connected networks. **Named evidence/example:** Blocked drains, weak maintenance, sewage mixing and fragmented agency responsibility.. **Analysis:** Project-based upgrades cannot substitute for catchment-scale operation.
- **Claim 4:** Lasting remedies combine spatial regulation and service management. **Named evidence/example:** Blue-green networks, floodplain zoning, drain inventory, forecasts, permeable surfaces and ward preparedness.. **Analysis:** Risk reduction must protect low-income settlements and critical infrastructure rather than merely accelerate drainage downstream.
- **Qualification:** Design standards must use updated rainfall and land-use evidence, but no engineering capacity can eliminate residual risk.
- **Verdict:** The durable strategy is catchment governance: protect storage and flow paths, manage waste and drainage continuously, regulate exposure and prepare for exceedance events.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

Account for the huge flooding of million cities in India including the smart ones like Hyderabad and Pune. Suggest lasting remedial measures. (250 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2020

HIGH

9. Workbook solved Mains PYQ - 2019

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Locally available official GS-I question paper verified.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** How is efficient and affordable urban mass transport key to the rapid economic development of India? (250 words)
- **Demand decoding:** 15 marks. Directive: Explain causal importance. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Mass transport enlarges effective labour markets. **Named evidence/example:** Metro, suburban rail and high-capacity bus systems connect workers to multiple employment nodes.. **Analysis:** Lower travel time and uncertainty improve job matching and firm productivity.
- **Claim 2:** Affordability converts physical connectivity into social access. **Named evidence/example:** Low-income workers often spend a high share of time and income on commuting.. **Analysis:** A costly network can induce exclusion, informal paratransit dependence or residential crowding near jobs.
- **Claim 3:** Mode shift reduces congestion, energy use and local pollution per passenger. **Named evidence/example:** Integrated bus-metro-rail systems and walking/cycling access.. **Analysis:** Benefits depend on occupancy, clean energy, network design and restraint on car-oriented sprawl.
- **Claim 4:** Transport shapes land values and urban form. **Named evidence/example:** Transit-oriented development around stations.. **Analysis:** Value capture can fund infrastructure, but displacement must be prevented through affordable housing and inclusive zoning.
- **Qualification:** A metro project alone is not a mobility system; feeder access, universal design, ticket integration, safety and land-use coordination are essential.
- **Verdict:** Efficient affordable mass transit is productive infrastructure because it improves access, agglomeration and environmental performance, provided it is designed as an inclusive door-to-door network.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** direct thesis; compact spatial diagram; mark-proportionate evidence; example-to-claim linkage; explicit counterpoint; decisive conclusion.
- **Examiner warning:** do not substitute a mission inventory for the causal or evaluative demand.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Use 2-3 named examples for 10 marks and 4-6 for 15 marks.
2. Maintain directive fidelity.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A list of city names is evidence.

CORRECT: Explain what each named example demonstrates.

MAINS ANGLE

How is efficient and affordable urban mass transport key to the rapid economic development of India? (250 words)

STUDY LINK

Official local GS-I scan, 2019

HIGH

10. Workbook solved Prelims PYQ

GS-I / GS-III

Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

UPSC Prelims 2019 GS-I Q59 - Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** As per the Solid Waste Management Rules, 2016 in India, which one of the following statements is correct?

- A. Waste generator has to segregate waste into five categories. | B. The Rules are applicable to notified urban local bodies, notified towns and all industrial townships only. | C. The Rules provide for exact and elaborate criteria for identification of sites for landfills and waste-processing facilities. | D. Waste generated in one district cannot be moved to another district.

- **Officially verified answer: C.** Officially verified answer: C. Five-category segregation is incorrect; applicability is wider than only notified urban bodies/towns/industrial townships; no blanket inter-district movement ban exists.

- **Elimination logic:** test the precise legal/statistical scope of each option; reject category compression and absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Official key verified.
2. No inferred-answer label required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A broadly plausible statement is enough.

CORRECT: Prelims turns on exact scope and wording.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective PYQ - verify each statement independently.

STUDY LINK

Local paper and key

HIGH

11. Workbook solved Prelims PYQ

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

UPSC Prelims 2024 GS-I Set A Q74 - Constitutional Parts

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Which statements are correct? 1. Powers of Municipalities are given in Part IX-A. 2. Emergency provisions are in Part XVIII. 3. Constitutional amendment provisions are in Part XX.

- A. 1 and 2 only | B. 2 and 3 only | C. 1 only | D. 1, 2 and 3

- **Officially verified answer: D.** Official key: D. Part IX-A concerns Municipalities; Part XVIII emergencies; Part XX amendment.

- **Elimination logic:** test the precise legal/statistical scope of each option; reject category compression and absolute wording.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Official key verified.
2. No inferred-answer label required.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A broadly plausible statement is enough.

CORRECT: Prelims turns on exact scope and wording.

MAINS ANGLE

Objective PYQ - verify each statement independently.

STUDY LINK

Local paper and key

HIGH

12. Hard MCQs 1-8

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Strict answer-key rotation continues A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q1. Which statement best distinguishes site from situation?**

- A. Site is immediate ground; situation is relational location | B. Site is relative accessibility; situation is geology | C. Both are population classes | D. Both are legal boundaries

- **Answer: A.** Site is local physical ground; situation is relative position.

- **Q2. A nucleated rural settlement most directly describes:**

- A. A statutory town | B. A compact dwelling cluster | C. A transport hierarchy | D. A city-region

- **Answer: B.** Nucleated refers to compact morphology.

- **Q3. Which model uses invasion-succession and a transition zone?**

- A. Hoyt | B. Harris-Ullman | C. Burgess | D. Christaller

- **Answer: C.** Burgess uses concentric zones and a transition zone.

- **Q4. Hoyt's main addition was:**

- A. Hexagonal markets | B. Rank-size relation | C. Multiple legal bodies | D. Sectoral growth along corridors

- **Answer: D.** Hoyt stressed directional sectors.

- **Q5. Multiple-nuclei theory explains:**

- A. Specialised nodes and incompatible land uses | B. Only one CBD | C. Rural hamlets | D. Census reclassification

- **Answer: A.** Specialised centres form several nuclei.

- **Q6. Bid-rent theory is primarily about:**

- A. Birth and death rates | B. Accessibility and land-use bids | C. Municipal elections | D. Waste segregation

- **Answer: B.** Users trade accessibility, transport cost and space.

- **Q7. Threshold in central-place theory is:**

- A. Maximum travel distance | B. Largest city population | C. Minimum sustaining demand | D. Municipal tax base

- **Answer: C.** Threshold is the minimum demand.

- **Q8. Range in central-place theory is:**

- A. Minimum population | B. Ward boundary | C. Rank-size exponent | D. Maximum acceptable travel for a good/service

- **Answer: D.** Range is maximum acceptable distance/time/cost.

HIGH

13. Hard MCQs 9-16

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Strict answer-key rotation continues A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q9. K=4 is associated with:**

- A. Transport | B. Marketing | C. Administration | D. Housing

- **Answer: A.** Christaller's K=4 is the transport principle.

- **Q10. Rank-size analysis requires:**

- A. Only a national capital | B. A defined urban system and comparable boundaries | C. A municipal election | D. A slum survey

- **Answer: B.** Scale and boundary definitions affect rank.

- **Q11. A census town requires:**

- A. Municipal notification | B. One million population | C. Three demographic-economic criteria | D. UA continuity

- **Answer: C.** It is statistically identified by three criteria.

- **Q12. An urban agglomeration requires:**

- A. Every constituent to be statutory | B. At least ten lakh population | C. State Finance Commission | D. Continuous urban spread with at least one statutory town

- **Answer: D.** UA is a built-up continuity concept.

- **Q13. Article 243P metropolitan area is:**

- A. A notified ≥ 10 lakh area meeting constitutional description | B. Any million-plus UA | C. Any district headquarters | D. Any Smart City

- **Answer: A.** It is a notified constitutional planning category.

- **Q14. Urbanisation differs from urban growth because:**

- A. They are identical | B. Urbanisation concerns change in urban share/system; growth can be absolute | C. Growth is only migration | D. Urbanisation excludes reclassification

- **Answer: B.** Share and absolute growth are distinct.

- **Q15. Which is not migration?**

- A. Net in-movement | B. Rural-urban move | C. Reclassification of a settlement | D. International relocation

- **Answer: C.** Reclassification changes category without movement.

- **Q16. Peri-urban area is best treated as:**

- A. One uniform Census class | B. A million-plus class | C. A municipal tax | D. A transition/planning concept

- **Answer: D.** There is no single national census test.

HIGH

14. Hard MCQs 17-24

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Strict answer-key rotation continues A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q17. Sprawl is best diagnosed through:**

- A. Discontinuity, land-use segregation, travel and network cost | B. Population alone | C. Building height alone | D. City name

- **Answer: A.** Sprawl is multidimensional.

- **Q18. TOD requires:**

- A. High FAR without transit | B. Transit, mix, walkability and inclusion | C. Parking-led growth | D. Only ring roads

- **Answer: B.** TOD integrates transit and land use.

- **Q19. A slum household count is:**

- A. Equal to housing shortage | B. A current projection | C. A distinct measure tied to a slum framework | D. A municipal revenue

- **Answer: C.** Do not conflate measures.

- **Q20. Agglomeration 'matching' means:**

- A. Waste segregation | B. Flood storage | C. Tax equalisation | D. Better worker-firm fit

- **Answer: D.** Thick markets improve matching.

- **Q21. Procedural justice concerns:**

- A. Participation and decision process | B. Only final income | C. Only land prices | D. Only project cost
- **Answer: A.** Voice and process are procedural.
- **Q22. Article 243W concerns:**
- A. Census town criteria | B. Municipal powers/responsibilities via state law | C. Emergency provisions | D. Union finance
- **Answer: B.** Article 243W addresses municipal functions.
- **Q23. MPC is provided under:**
- A. 243W | B. 352 | C. 243ZE | D. 368
- **Answer: C.** Article 243ZE provides Metropolitan Planning Committees.
- **Q24. Which is own-source ULB revenue?**
- A. Union income tax | B. World Bank projection | C. Census count | D. Property tax
- **Answer: D.** Property tax is a municipal own-source instrument.

HIGH**15. Hard MCQs 25-32****GS-I / GS-III**
Geography**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Strict answer-key rotation continues A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q25. A tap connection is not proof of:**
- A. Continuity, quality and affordability | B. A recorded connection | C. Capital expenditure | D. Network existence
- **Answer: A.** Service outcomes require more than connection.
- **Q26. Safe sewerage assessment includes:**
- A. Only sanctioned capacity | B. Collection, treatment compliance, sludge and receiving water | C. Only pipe length | D. Only expenditure
- **Answer: B.** The whole chain matters.
- **Q27. SWM processing rate needs:**
- A. Only a headline | B. Urban share | C. Denominator and reject/final-disposal data | D. Rank-size
- **Answer: C.** Material-flow accounting is essential.
- **Q28. Mass transit supports productivity mainly by:**
- A. Increasing parking | B. Reducing all density | C. Replacing land-use planning | D. Enlarging effective labour markets
- **Answer: D.** Access improves matching and agglomeration.
- **Q29. Urban heat vulnerability is highest where:**
- A. Exposure and sensitivity are high and capacity low | B. Only temperature is high | C. Buildings are tall | D. Municipal boundary is large
- **Answer: A.** Risk is multidimensional.

- **Q30. The lasting urban-flood approach is:**

- A. Only larger drains | B. Catchment-scale storage, flow and exposure management | C. Only relief camps | D. Only road elevation

- **Answer: B.** Catchment governance addresses causes.

- **Q31. Mission completion is:**

- A. A guaranteed welfare outcome | B. A Census estimate | C. An administrative output requiring outcome verification | D. A constitutional category

- **Answer: C.** Output-outcome firewall.

- **Q32. UN WUP 2025 should be cited as:**

- A. A new Indian Census | B. A municipal law | C. A housing sanction | D. An estimate/projection series with a harmonised method

- **Answer: D.** It is not the Indian Census.

HIGH

16. Remedial MCQs 33-40

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Strict answer-key rotation continues A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- **Q33. Which correction is necessary?**

- A. 31.16% is Census 2011 | B. 31.16% is India's current observed urban share | C. 951m is Census 2050 | D. PMAY sanction is occupancy

- **Answer: A.** The baseline needs its date.

- **Q34. Which pair is wrongly conflated?**

- A. UA and built-up continuity | B. Metropolitan area and automatic million-plus Census class | C. Threshold and demand | D. TOD and transit

- **Answer: B.** Constitutional notification differs from Census size.

- **Q35. Which statement about census towns is false?**

- A. They may lack a municipality | B. They use a male main-worker criterion | C. They are created only by municipal law | D. They meet density and population tests

- **Answer: C.** They are statistical, not necessarily statutory.

- **Q36. Which measure best checks distributive justice?**

- A. Citywide average only | B. Project count | C. Budget announcement | D. Ward/group-wise access and affordability

- **Answer: D.** Distribution requires disaggregation.

- **Q37. Which model error is common?**

- A. Treating ideal form as universal map | B. Stating assumptions | C. Using named evidence | D. Adding qualification

- **Answer: A.** Models are heuristic.

- **Q38. Which housing response protects livelihoods most directly?**

- A. Distant relocation by default | B. In-situ upgrading where safe and feasible | C. Demolition without plan | D. Ownership-only targeting

- **Answer: B.** Location and networks matter.

- **Q39. Which finance statement is safest?**

- A. Bond issuance proves solvency | B. Grants eliminate accountability | C. Debt needs predictable revenue and O&M | D. PPP has no fiscal risk

- **Answer: C.** Lifecycle and debt service matter.

- **Q40. Which closing verdict is strongest?**

- A. Urban growth must stop | B. Mission totals prove success | C. Technology alone will solve urbanisation | D. Align functional regions, empowered ULBs, universal services and ecological limits

- **Answer: D.** The integrated verdict follows the full analysis.

HIGH

17. Workbook Original solved Mains practice - 10 marks

 GS-I / GS-III
 Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Original examiner-oriented practice question.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Examine why India's urban challenge is better understood as a mismatch among functional regions, governing boundaries and service systems than as population growth alone. (10 marks)
- **Demand decoding:** 10 marks. Directive: Examine. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Functional urban regions cross statutory borders. **Named evidence/example:** Delhi NCR-type commuting and airshed/watershed systems.. **Analysis:** Municipal decisions cannot alone govern regional flows.
- **Claim 2:** Census and legal categories change at different speeds. **Named evidence/example:** 3,894 census towns in Census 2011.. **Analysis:** Dense non-farm settlements can remain under rural governance and service norms.
- **Claim 3:** Infrastructure is networked across jurisdictions. **Named evidence/example:** Water source, landfill, transit corridor and flood catchment.. **Analysis:** Fragmentation creates cost shifting and accountability gaps.
- **Qualification:** Population growth remains a pressure multiplier, but the same growth produces different outcomes under different institutional capacity.
- **Verdict:** India needs boundary-aware municipal devolution plus metropolitan/catchment coordination and outcome-based service monitoring.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** include a labelled diagram, sufficient named evidence, explicit qualification and a verdict proportional to the directive.

HIGH

18. Workbook Original solved Mains practice - 15 marks

 GS-I / GS-III
 Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Original examiner-oriented practice question.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** Analyse how land-use planning, housing and mobility can jointly reduce urban inequality and climate risk in Indian cities. (15 marks)

- **Demand decoding:** 15 marks. Directive: Analyse. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.

- **Claim 1:** Risk-sensitive land use reduces exposure. **Named evidence/example:** Protection of wetlands/floodplains and heat-sensitive open-space networks.. **Analysis:** Avoidance is cheaper and more equitable than repeated post-disaster recovery.

- **Claim 2:** Well-located affordable housing lowers livelihood and transport vulnerability. **Named evidence/example:** In-situ upgrading, rental housing and mixed-income TOD.. **Analysis:** Location turns a dwelling into access to jobs, care and education.

- **Claim 3:** Mass transit and active mobility expand opportunity while limiting emissions. **Named evidence/example:** Integrated bus-metro-suburban rail with safe last mile.. **Analysis:** Affordable door-to-door access supports agglomeration without car dependence.

- **Claim 4:** Municipal finance and participation sustain the package. **Named evidence/example:** Property-tax reform, O&M budgets, ward committees and public dashboards.. **Analysis:** Capital projects endure only with revenue and local accountability.

- **Qualification:** Higher density can worsen heat or displacement if infrastructure, ventilation and affordability safeguards are absent.

- **Verdict:** An integrated land-housing-mobility strategy should be evaluated through ward-wise access, affordability and risk outcomes rather than project counts.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.

- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** include a labelled diagram, sufficient named evidence, explicit qualification and a verdict proportional to the directive.

HIGH

19. Workbook Original solved Mains practice - 20 marks

GS-I / GS-III
Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Original examiner-oriented practice question.

STATIC THEORY

- **Question:** India's next urban transition must be municipal, metropolitan and ecological at the same time. Discuss with reference to the 74th Amendment and current urban missions. (20 marks)
- **Demand decoding:** 20 marks. Directive: Discuss. Define the key term, answer the causal/evaluative demand, use named spatial evidence, qualify scale and end with a direct verdict.
- **Claim 1:** Municipal capacity is the democratic service foundation. **Named evidence/example:** Part IX-A, Article 243W and the Twelfth Schedule.. **Analysis:** Functions without funds, staff and answerability create constitutional form without operational capacity.
- **Claim 2:** Metropolitan coordination is required for networked regions. **Named evidence/example:** Article 243ZE MPC; commuting, housing, watershed, airshed and waste flows.. **Analysis:** Local autonomy and regional integration must be designed together.
- **Claim 3:** Ecological systems are urban infrastructure. **Named evidence/example:** Blue-green flood networks, heat mitigation, source-water security and circular waste systems.. **Analysis:** Ignoring ecological capacity converts growth into recurrent fiscal and social loss.
- **Claim 4:** Missions supply instruments but not automatic outcomes. **Named evidence/example:** PMAY-U 2.0 sanctions, AMRUT approvals, SBM processing status and Smart Cities project completion.. **Analysis:** Each statistic needs an outcome test: occupancy, continuity, residuals, inclusion and O&M.
- **Claim 5:** Finance determines scale and durability. **Named evidence/example:** Urban Challenge Fund, own revenue, grants, bonds and lifecycle costing.. **Analysis:** Market-linked capital can expand investment but may exclude weak ULBs or create fiscal risk without equalisation and capacity.
- **Qualification:** One uniform model cannot fit statutory towns, census towns, Tier 2 centres and mega city-regions; state and city variation must remain visible.
- **Verdict:** The transition should combine empowered ULBs, accountable metropolitan institutions and ecological limits, monitored through disaggregated service and resilience outcomes.
- **Why this earns marks:** It answers the directive directly, links each claim to named evidence, explains the spatial mechanism, includes a limitation and gives a reasoned verdict rather than a scheme list.
- **Outstanding-answer checklist:** include a labelled diagram, sufficient named evidence, explicit qualification and a verdict proportional to the directive.